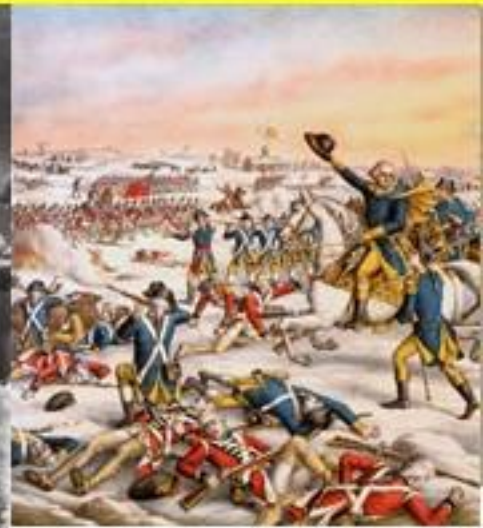


WORLD HISTORY



MODULE - 20

**THE SOCIALISM AND LABOR
MOVEMENTS IN EUROPE - 3**

1 THE FIRST INTERNATIONAL, 1864

- 1 Formation of “International Working Men’s Association” or the First International in 1864 is one of the most important event in the history of Socialist movement. It was held at a mass meeting in London on Sept. 28, 1864.
- 2 Its founders were among the most powerful British and French trade-union leaders of the time. Though Karl Marx had no part in organizing the meeting, he was elected one of the 32 members of the provisional General Council and at once assumed its leadership.
- 3 The International Workingmen's Association, often called the First International, was an international organisation which aimed at uniting a variety of different left-wing socialist, communist and anarchist groups and trade unions that were based on the working class and class struggle.



1 THE FIRST INTERNATIONAL, 1864

4 With its formation, it has been said, “Socialism stepped on the stage of history as a world movement”

5 The emancipation of the working classes, it was declared, must be won by the working classes themselves.

6 The central aim of the International was declared to be the total ‘abolition of all class rule’.

7 The Address ended with the slogan, as in the Communist Manifesto, “Proletarians of all lands, unite!”

8 It was persecuted and declared illegal in many countries.



IMPACT/CONTRIBUTION OF FIRST INTERNATIONAL

1 The International exercised a tremendous influence on workers' movements in Europe and North America.

2 Created bonds of international solidarity by arranging aid from workers of many countries in support of the workers' struggle in any particular country.

EXAMPLE

When in 1867, 5000 bronze workers in Paris who had formed a union were threatened with dismissal, the International collected money for them; from workers in other countries and forced the 'factory owners to withdraw their threats.

3 Despite low membership it created sense of Worker Solidarity and was feared by Rulers e.g. workers' solidarity was evidenced at the time of the war between Prussia and France in 1870. Both German & French workers condemned.



2 THE PARIS COMMUNE, 1871

- 1 The Paris Commune was a radical socialist and revolutionary government that ruled Paris from 18 March to 28 May 1871.
- 2 The Franco-Prussian War had led to the capture of Emperor Napoleon III in September 1870, the collapse of the Second French Empire, and the beginning of the Third Republic.
- 3 Paris was primarily defended during this time by the often politicised and radical troops of the National Guard rather than regular Army troops
- 4 Paris surrendered to the Prussians on 28 January 1871, and in February Adolphe Thiers, the new chief executive of the French national government, signed an armistice with Prussia that disarmed the Army but not the National Guard.



2

THE PARIS COMMUNE, 1871

5 The new government dominated by the propertied class came and declared France a republic. It also agreed to Bismarck's terms for truce including:

- Surrender of Paris
- Cession of Alsace-Lorraine and
- Payment of a huge war indemnity.

6 Workers regarded this as treacherous and refused to surrender.



Bismarck

2

THE PARIS COMMUNE, 1871

7 The workers of Paris elected a council which on 28 March 1871 assumed the title of the Paris Commune. It was elected by universal adult franchise and represented the workers and the lower middle classes of Paris.

8 The Paris Commune was the result of an upsurge in which the workers had played the dominant role, the result of the first workers' revolution in history.

9 French Government which had established its headquarters in Versailles attacked Paris along with German help and exterminated the Commune.



THE DEMISE OF 1ST INTERNATIONAL

- The extermination of the Commune was followed by systematic attempts to destroy the International in almost every country of Europe.
- It collapsed as a result of internal differences.
- The International was not a homogeneous organisation
- It represented many different trends in the workers' movement.
- Due to differences on aims and methods, it was split in 1872 and was formally dissolved in 1876.



3 THE SECOND INTERNATIONAL

- 1 The Second International was an organisation of socialist and labour parties, held at Paris meeting in which **delegations from twenty countries participated.**
- 2 By 1880's in almost every country socialist parties were formed; they participated in national elections and in some countries they had fairly large representation. E.g. German Socialist party
- 3 Strength and membership of the trade unions also increased e.g. Social Democratic federation with million members in Britain
- 4 Growth of socialism happened in almost all countries including France, America, Japan etc.



3 THE SECOND INTERNATIONAL

- 5 To unite the socialist parties in various countries into an international organization, a Congress was held in Paris on 14 July 1889, the centenary of the French Revolution of 1789. The **result of this was** what has come to be known as the Second International.
- 6 Congress decided to observe First May as a day of Working Class Solidarity.
- 7 Period after the formation the Second International saw a steady increase in the strength of the socialist parties and of trade unions. Membership of Socialist parties and trade union increased.
- 8 Socialist and workers' movement had become a major force in almost every country of Europe.



ACHIEVEMENTS OF 2ND INTERNATIONAL

- 1** ➤ Campaign against militarism and war and in asserting the principle of the basic equality of all peoples and their right to freedom and national independence.
- 2** ➤ International also decided that the socialists should utilize the “economic and political crisis created by the war, to arouse the masses and thereby to hasten the downfall of capitalist rule”.
- 3** The socialist movement had made the international solidarity of workers as a fundamental principle.



ACHIEVEMENTS OF 2ND INTERNATIONAL

4 When Russia and Japan were warring on each other, the leader of the Japanese socialist group and the leader of the Russian socialists were made the joint presidents of the Second International at its Congress in 1904.

5 Socialist tried to prevent their countries from participating in wars.

6 Second International also condemned colonialism and committed the socialist parties to oppose the robbery and subjugation of colonial peoples.



LIMITATIONS OF 2ND INTERNATIONAL

1 Unlike the First International, it was a loose federation of socialist parties of many countries.

Various differences among different sections

- 2**
- ✓ Some believed revolution necessary to overthrow capitalism others advocated achieving socialism through gradual reforms
 - ✓ Some sections were willing to support national government in certain situations
 - ✓ Some favoured colonialism too.



LIMITATIONS OF 2ND INTERNATIONAL

3 Although they were against war, some did not want to organize thinking they would be crushed. They were also not willing to utilize war to promote revolution.

4 It was on the question of the war that the Second International suffered a fatal blow. When the First World War broke out, most of the socialist parties extended their support to their respective governments.

5 This had serious consequences for the socialist movement. The Second International ceased to function and the socialist movement in every country was split.



EVALUATION OF 2ND INTERNATIONAL

1

- Although it didn't bring any social revolution but brought awareness about problems created by capitalism & the inadequacies of Democracy

2

- Emerged as powerful political movement in many countries.

Second International Sends Message to Zionist Labor Conference

Berlin.—(J.T.A.)—A message from the second Socialist International taking note of the growth of the Zionist Labor movement, was read at the international conference of the Zionist Labor party, Poale Zion, in session here.

The International also sent a message of congratulations to the International Ladies Garment Workers Union of New York upon the successful conclusion of its strike this week.

- 1 After Russian revolution, the Communist International (also known as the Third International or Comintern) was formed for promoting revolutions on an international scale.
- 2 It was an association of national communist parties founded in 1919. Though its stated purpose was the promotion of world revolution, the Comintern functioned chiefly as an organ of Soviet control over the international communist movement.
- 3 The left-wing sections in many socialist parties now formed themselves into communist parties and they affiliated themselves to the Comintern.
- 4 Thus the international communist movement arose under one organization which decided on policies to be followed by all communist parties.
- 5 With the formation of the Comintern, the socialist movement was divided into two sections — socialist and communist. Differing in methods and idea of socialism itself.



FORMATION OF COMINTERN

- 1** The Comintern emerged from the three-way split in the socialist Second International over the issue of World War I.
- 2** A majority of socialist parties, comprising the International's "right" wing, chose to support the war efforts of their respective national governments against enemies that they saw as far more hostile to socialist aims.
- 3** The "centre" faction of the International decried the nationalism of the right and sought the reunification of the Second International under the banner of world peace.
- 4** The "left" group, led by Vladimir Lenin, rejected both nationalism and pacifism, urging instead a socialist drive to transform the war of nations into a transnational class war.
- 5** In 1915 Lenin proposed the creation of a new International to promote "civil war, not civil peace" through propaganda directed at soldiers and workers.



FORMATION OF COMINTERN

- 6** Two years later Lenin led the Bolshevik seizure of power in Russia, and in 1919 he called the first congress of the Comintern, in Moscow, specifically to undermine ongoing centrist efforts to revive the Second International.
- 7** Only 19 delegations and a few non-Russian communists who happened to be in Moscow attended this first congress; but the second, meeting in Moscow in 1920, was attended by delegates from 37 countries.
- 8** There **Lenin** established the Twenty-one Points, the conditions of admission to the Communist International.
- 9** These prerequisites for Comintern membership required all parties to model their structure on disciplined lines in conformity with the Soviet pattern and to expel moderate socialists and pacifists.



DIFFERENCE BETWEEN COMMUNISM AND SOCIALISM

1 Under communism, there is no such thing as private property. All property is communally owned, and each person receives a portion based on what they need. A strong central government—the state—controls all aspects of economic production, and provides citizens with their basic necessities, including food, housing, medical care and education.

2 By contrast, under socialism, individuals can still own property. But industrial production, or the chief means of generating wealth, is communally owned and managed by a democratically elected government.



DIFFERENCE BETWEEN COMMUNISM AND SOCIALISM

3 An early distinction between communism and socialism was that the latter aimed to only socialise production while the former aimed to socialise both production and consumption (in the form of free access to final goods).

4 The main difference is that under communism, most property and economic resources are owned and controlled by the state (rather than individual citizens).

5 While under socialism, all citizens share equally in economic resources as allocated by a democratically-elected government.

EXAMPLES

SOCIALISM

You have 2 cows.
You give one to your neighbour.

COMMUNISM

You have 2 cows.
The State takes both and gives you some milk.

QUESTIONS FOR PRACTICE

1. "The proletarians have nothing to lose but their chains.. workers of the world, unite!" Comment.
150 words
2. Elaborate on the difference between socialist and capitalist economic philosophy.
150 words
3. What are the major shortcomings in the philosophy of Karl Marx?
150 words

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For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

For Information:

info.learningspacedigital@gmail.com

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0866 244 44 72

98499 42299

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